~/the-commit $ git log --since="2026-10-29" --oneline

HEAD → 0c5713f

The Commit

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Twice weekly · Mon & Thu

COVER STORY · CRYPTO SECURITY

FBI blames North Korea for Binance theft

The exchange says it has covered most stolen assets, while the FBI links the record heist to state-sponsored hackers.

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Binance says it covered 95% of stolen assets. It still needs to buy tokens to complete recovery from the $6.3 billion theft.

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01 COVER STORY Crypto security

FBI blames North Korea for Binance theft

The exchange says it has covered most stolen assets, while the FBI links the record heist to state-sponsored hackers.

src: bleepingcomputer.com · BleepingComputer · 3 min read

The FBI has attributed the $6.3 billion theft from cryptocurrency exchange Binance to North Korean state-sponsored hackers known as TraderTraitor. BleepingComputer reports that the attack, around October 29, is the largest cryptocurrency heist on record. The group is also tracked under names including Lazarus Group and APT38.

Binance said it was preparing to resume the first phase of withdrawals on November 1 between 06:00 and 09:00 UTC. The exchange said it had covered approximately 95% of the affected amount, compared with 90% in its previous update. The remaining portion consisted of less-liquid tokens it was continuing to buy through market and over-the-counter channels.

The attribution places the incident in a longer pattern of attacks on cryptocurrency businesses and their staff. North Korean hackers have impersonated recruiters, using fake employment tests to induce employees to run malicious code. That history does not establish how this Binance attack worked. The immediate test is whether the exchange completes recovery and restores services while strengthening the safeguards it says it is reviewing.

02 TECH RADAR

NASA seeks Hubble rescue ideas

NASA is asking companies about boosting, servicing or safely disposing of Hubble. The request seeks options and costs; it commits no money to a rescue.

src: arstechnica.com

Linux flaw enables remote takeover

Anthropic researchers demonstrated remote root access against Linux servers running Multipath TCP listeners. The flaw also affects ordinary TCP, where such exploitation remains publicly undemonstrated.

src: bleepingcomputer.com

Florida financial aid data exposed

Florida says a financial aid website breach exposed sensitive data on 4.9 million people, including Social Security numbers. Officials say aid payments will continue.

src: therecord.media

Cursor removes compromised extensions

Phorion reported a backdoor in Claude Code extension bundles on Cursor's marketplace. Cursor removed two affected versions; extensions can access files with their user's permissions.

src: phorion.io

03 AI Teen safety

OpenAI tightens weapons information limits for teens

New restrictions and planned violence interventions will roll out over coming weeks; a safety report is promised for 2027.

src: openai.com · 2026-10-29

OpenAI says it is tightening limits on weapons information for ChatGPT users under 18. The rules cover practical details about weapons and security systems even when a question shows no violent intent. They extend existing bans on helping people carry out violence or helping teens obtain weapons. The company says the safeguards will start rolling out over the next few weeks.

ChatGPT will be able to end chats that suggest a fixation on seriously harming someone. Repeated incidents may lead to an account pause. Age prediction will assess signals as people use the service and move suspected teens into its protected experience. Adults wrongly classified can verify their age through Persona. OpenAI is also working on parental alerts when a linked teen account is paused for repeated discussion of violence.

A Community Safety Report is promised for early 2027, covering the second half of 2026, then every six months. OpenAI says it will share anonymized examples, policy changes and supporting safety data. The announcement describes planned safeguards; it does not establish how well they work.

04 MODEL WATCH

Thu 29 Oct → Mon 2 Nov

NEW FROM THE LABS	SIZE	CAPABILITIES
Mistral Large 4 MISTRAL · 29 OCT	1T	
Mage-VL-Cowork MICROSOFT · 30 OCT	4.7B	
Voxtral Mini Realtime Arabic MISTRAL · 8 OCT	4.4B	

TRENDING ON HUGGING FACE	SIZE	CAPABILITIES
DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash-1017 DEEPSEEK · #1	763.2B	
Unlimited-OCR-2 BAIDU · #5	3.3B	
LFM3-Omni-2B LIQUID AI · #14	2.2B	

Reasoning · Vision · Coding · Agents & tool use · Speech & audio · Video · Open weights

06 SEMICONDUCTORS Thu 29 Oct → Mon 2 Nov

MATERIALS RECYCLING

TANAKA plans Malaysian precious-metal refinery

A joint venture targets local recycling for electronics and chipmaking, with operations scheduled for April 2029.

src: semiconductor-digest.com · 2026-10-29

TANAKA says it will form a precious-metal recycling and refining venture with Malaysia's MEP Enviro Technology. The planned firm will be based in Batu Kawan Industrial Park in Penang. TANAKA will hold 66.7% and MEP 33.3%. The plant is due to start operations in April 2029; it is not producing metal today.

MEP will supply preprocessed recovered material for analysis and refining. The partners initially plan to make gold at 99.99% purity and potassium gold cyanide for electrical, electronics and chip customers. The venture builds on a technical assistance deal signed in August 2024. It would add refining to the partners' existing local recovery work.

The firms link the plan to factory scrap, tighter environmental rules and demand for local recycling. Recovering metals near chip and electronics plants could support regional supply. No processing capacity is given, however, and the expected benefit to stable procurement remains a company claim rather than a measured result.

07 CHIP BRIEFING

DDR4 rises despite weak PC demand

DDR4 8Gb contract prices averaged $27.50 in October, up 5.77% from September, according to DRAMeXchange data reported by SemiMedia. Supply cuts are supporting prices despite weak PC demand. TrendForce forecasts further PC memory price rises as suppliers prioritize servers; its projected output reductions are forecasts, rather than completed capacity changes.

src: semimedia.cc

Japanese equipment billings hit record

Japan's semiconductor equipment billings reached ¥629.04 billion in September, up 48.2% from a year earlier, the industry association reported. The measure includes exports and uses a three-month moving average. It signals strong equipment spending, rather than finished chip output. Supplier DISCO separately forecasts another shipment record for October through December.

src: semimedia.cc

Intel's bridges offer a foundry entry point

Intel's EMIB packaging connects neighboring chiplets through small silicon bridges, letting customers combine dies from different foundries. SemiWiki argues that packaging could attract customers without requiring a full wafer-manufacturing commitment. Intel claims cost and flexibility advantages. Larger assemblies, including at least sixteen high-bandwidth memory stacks by 2028, remain roadmap targets.

src: semiwiki.com

08 EXPLAINER full piece ~9 min

HARDWARE SECURITY

Europe’s security duties reach into the chip supply chain

The Cyber Resilience Act makes component evidence part of product security, extending the work beyond the company selling the finished device.

src: semiengineering.com · Semiconductor Engineering · 2026-10-29

A digital product’s security depends partly on components its maker did not design. Europe’s Cyber Resilience Act brings that supply chain into view: companies supplying digital products to the EU must consider its requirements, including when their contribution goes into somebody else’s finished product. Where the supplier is based, or where development happens, does not remove that responsibility.

The regulation applies to semiconductors sold separately. Finished-product manufacturers must also exercise due diligence when incorporating third-party components. Suppliers of semiconductor intellectual property, the designs incorporated into chips, may need to share security evaluation results and the assumptions under which their designs can be used securely. That information helps customers understand what the component evidence actually covers.

Reporting is already relevant. The mandatory reporting phase began in September 2026. When a manufacturer learns of an actively exploited product vulnerability or a severe security incident, it must submit an early warning, followed by a fuller notification and a final account of findings and corrective measures. Notifications go through the CRA’s Single Reporting Platform.

The precise duties depend on the product’s classification and how it is placed on the market. The law lists chip types including microprocessors, microcontrollers and programmable devices, considering their core functions. A supplier therefore needs to establish which responsibilities apply before promising customers a particular package of compliance evidence.

Useful documentation includes risk assessments, relevant design information and supporting evidence. Dated, repeatable evaluations can identify the design examined, what was tested and the limits of the results. The act specifies security outcomes without mandating one evaluation method. For suppliers and customers, the practical task is to identify relevant EU-bound product versions early and align evidence and development schedules before designs are finished.

BYTE-SIZED JOKE

My password manager started writing poetry. Every verse needed a special character.

09 COMPANY ACTIONS Thu 29 Oct → Mon 2 Nov

Pollution lawsuit survives dismissal attempt

A federal judge allowed the NAACP's lawsuit over turbines powering xAI's Colossus data center to proceed. Plaintiffs allege it operated at least 35 turbines without required air permits. xAI argued the machines were mobile and exempt. Judge Debra M. Brown rejected that argument and upheld plaintiffs' standing, allowing the Clean Air Act claims to continue through the courts.

X XAI · techcrunch.com

AWS growth accelerates amid heavy spending

Amazon reported 39.3% growth in AWS sales for the quarter ended September 30, compared with 37% in the preceding quarter. The company called it the fastest growth in nearly five years. Its cautious fourth-quarter sales outlook accompanied the latest quarterly results. Amazon previously raised its annual capital-spending expectation to $220 billion, mostly for AI, citing higher memory costs.

A AMAZON · theguardian.com

China AI beta will integrate Qwen

Apple plans to begin mainland China testing of Apple Intelligence on November 4, integrating Alibaba's Qwen into Siri, Writing Tools and Visual Intelligence, TechNode reports. A developer beta precedes a wider iOS 27.3 release planned for December. Users will be able to ask about text, images and documents; other Apple platforms must await necessary approvals before receiving support.

APPLE · technode.com

Fundraising target falls to $20 billion

OpenAI is seeking up to $20 billion in its latest funding round, down from an earlier target of about $30 billion, CNBC reports. The Financial Times put the proposed post-money valuation at $1.25 trillion. A person familiar with the deal told CNBC the round has not closed, leaving those figures subject to change before any final investment agreement.

O OPENAI · cnbc.com

Sales records intensify pressure on smaller rivals

BYD reported 490,168 worldwide deliveries last month, up 11% from a year earlier, while Geely reported 310,183 petrol and electric vehicle deliveries, up 1%. Their gains contrast with a domestic market downturn, the South China Morning Post reports. Analyst Gao Shen says leading makers' new models and cost advantages increase pressure on weaker competitors already struggling to survive.

B BYD AND GEELY · scmp.com

Lumentum acquisition talks remain unfinished

Marvell is in advanced talks to buy optical components supplier Lumentum, SemiMedia reports, citing people familiar with the discussions. No final agreement, price or payment structure has been announced. A deal would combine Marvell's connectivity chips and optical signal processors with Lumentum's lasers and other components for high-speed links within and between AI data centers around the world.

M MARVELL · semimedia.cc

10 COMPANY ACTIONS CONTINUED

Thu 29 Oct → Mon 2 Nov

Flash revenue rises as AI demand grows

Sandisk's SSD revenues rose 378% from a year earlier to a record $11 billion, Blocks & Files reports. The company forecasts total revenue of $12.4 billion, plus or minus $200 million, for its next fiscal quarter. Sandisk says long-term customer signals extend beyond fiscal 2030 as AI expands flash demand. It is also working with SK Hynix on high-bandwidth flash, stacking NAND dies with vertical connections to overcome conventional SSD bandwidth and latency limits. That remains a technology bet: the report says no GPU supplier has committed to adopting it.

SANDISK · blocksandfiles.com

Court files reveal discussions to undermine critic

Meta employees discussed a strategy to undermine social psychologist Jonathan Haidt, according to meeting notes in a US court filing reported by the Guardian. The notes discuss encouraging academics to disavow his work and making media view him as less credible. The material predates his 2024 book on smartphones and young people's mental health. It is unclear whether Meta acted on the ideas. Statistician Andrew Gelman, apparently referenced in the notes, said he was never hired by Facebook to attack Haidt and had not been asked to study social media's effects on teenagers.

META · theguardian.com

11 MARKETS

29 Oct → 1 Nov

S&P 500	NASDAQ	EURO STOXX 50	BITCOIN
▼ −1.8%	▼ −2.9%	▼ −1.2%	▲ +0.6%
7,580	25,437	6,131	78,248

▲ BIGGEST GAINERS

+0.4%	SAP SAP	$235
+0.1%	Netflix NFLX	$62.08

▼ BIGGEST LOSERS

−28.6%	Intel INTC	$65.76
−10.9%	AMD AMD	$505
−10.6%	Coinbase COIN	$144

Change between daily closes · finance.yahoo.com · not investment advice

12 WORLD REPORT Thu 29 Oct → Mon 2 Nov

Qatar mediates to avert renewed Iran attacks

Qatar is mediating to prevent possible renewed US attacks on Iran, NPR reports. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said talks had reached no definitive conclusion, but described a possible two-day arrangement involving a halt to attacks on Strait of Hormuz shipping. The proposal could reopen direct Washington-Tehran talks as Gulf states face continuing uncertainty over the war.

GULF · npr.org

Alert systems targeted as regional truce ends

Russia and Ukraine reported attacks on emergency alert systems as a ceasefire limited to Kherson expired. Kyiv said Moscow refused an extension; Russia reported a major attack on its warnings app after Ukraine reported false radiation alerts. Separately, energy provider DTEK said emergency power cuts took effect in Kyiv and the surrounding region on grid operator orders.

UKRAINE · france24.com

UN mission ends after Security Council impasse

The UN peacekeeping mission in disputed Western Sahara ceased operations after 35 years, NPR reports, following a US-Russia standoff. Russia vetoed a US draft supporting Moroccan sovereignty that would have ended the mission next year. The territory is claimed by Morocco and the Polisario Front. The UN secretary-general warned of escalating hostilities and urged maximum restraint.

WESTERN SAHARA · npr.org

Hospitals report eight killed despite ceasefire

Israeli strikes killed at least eight people in Gaza, including a four-year-old boy, hospitals said, despite the ceasefire established in October last year. Israel says it targets Hamas; civilians continue to be killed. The BBC reports that the US-brokered peace plan has stalled, while Gaza's Hamas-run health ministry reports 1,580 deaths since the ceasefire began.

GAZA · bbc.co.uk

German cost-of-living protests turn violent

Shops were looted in Frankfurt as cost-of-living protests brought clashes in several German cities. Police said demonstrators targeted emergency workers with fireworks, stones and bottles. Berlin police reported 27 officers injured and up to 56 people temporarily detained. The unrest accompanied wider European protests, including largely peaceful French demonstrations demanding action on living costs and public services.

EUROPE · bbc.co.uk

Coastal evacuations begin before second cyclone

Andhra Pradesh authorities began evacuating coastal residents ahead of Cyclone Murasu, days after another cyclone struck the region. State disaster official Prakhar Jain said about 2,000 people had been moved, with plans to evacuate around 30,000. India's weather service forecast landfall near Ongole overnight. Officials warned of serious threats to electricity supplies as the region continued recovering.

INDIA · aljazeera.com